rice. They are easily digestible and hence good for children and old people. It adds variety in the diet. Rice flakes are a good source of iron.

2.3.2. Wheat

Wheat grains are ovoid in shape rounded in both ends. Wheat proteins are rich in glutamic acid and low in tryptophan. Whole wheat is a good source of thiamin, riboflavin, niacin, folic acid, calcium, phosphorus, zinc, copper and iron. Wheat is also a good source of fibre. Wheat is consumed mostly in the form of flour obtained by milling the grain while a small quantity is converted into breakfast foods such as wheat flakes and puffed wheat.

Wheat is milled to produce flour which is used to make a variety of products including bread across the world. Wheat contains a protein called gluten which is necessary for the basic structure in forming the dough system for bread, rolls and other baked goods. Many of the foods we consume on a daily basis such as bread, cookies, cakes, pies, pastries, cereals, crackers, pasta, flour tortillas and noodles are all made from wheat flour.



Fig 2.4: Wheat

Products of wheat

Whole wheat flour: It contains the finely ground bran, germ and endosperm of the whole kernel. It is used in making chapathis, puris, whole wheat bread, etc.

DO YOU KNOW...?

Some interesting Facts about wheat

- Malted wheat is used in health drinks and in alcoholic drinks after distillation.
- Wheat is used for cattle, poultry, and other livestock feed.
- Young wheatgrass is becoming increasingly popular as a nutritional supplement offering vitamin A, B-complex, C, E, and K.
- Some strains of wheat are grown to produce starch in South Asia used in textile manufacturing.
- In many countries, rural houses still use wheat straw to thatch their houses as well as mattresses and pillows.
- Wheat is also being used for plastics manufacturing and aquaculture feed purposes for both fish and shrimp.

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